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Predictors of Engaging in Interracial Dating

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Abstract

Research suggests that mixed-race adolescents are more likely than monoracial adolescents to use drugs or engage in violent behavior, and that interracial relationships contain more conflict than monoracial ones. However, it is not clear whether these outcomes are caused by racial conflict and identity or by self-selection. To determine this, we used data from the NLSY97 and Add Health datasets to explore what characteristics predict whether an individual is engaged in an interracial relationship. Our investigation suggests that assortative mating occurs between races, where individuals who date individuals of other races tend to be more similar to them. The standardized difference in intelligence between those interracially mated and those who didn't varied by race (White d = -0.22, $p < .001$; Black d = 0.31, $p < .001$; Hispanic d = 0.73, $p < .001$). Also, there is a difference in height between Hispanics who interracially dated and those who didn't (mean d = 0.29, $p < .001$). Interracial daters tended to engage in a broader range of risk-taking behaviors (White d = 0.18, $p < .01$; Black d = 0.42, $p < .01$; Hispanic d = 0.53, $p < .001$) regardless of their race. The available evidence supports that the behavior of mixed-race adolescents is a product of genetic transmission, and that some of the increased divorce and inter-partner violence observed within interracial relationships may be a product of self-selection instead of racial conflict or social pressure.

Keywords: Assortative mating, Intelligence, Race, Psychopathology

1 Introduction

Interracial relationships have been an intriguing topic ever since they were made legal in every US state by the Supreme Court in 1967 (Loving v. Virginia). Most research in this area has focused on differences in relationship satisfaction and divorce rate between endogamous and mixed-race couples (Bratter & Eschbach, 2006; Brooks, 2021; Brown et al., 2018). Some research has also tried to assess the characteristics of those who engage in interracial relationships (Todd et al., 1992), which is necessary to evaluate the cause of disparities in satisfaction or divorce between interracial and intraracial couples. This is because differences in traits that influence individuals to engage in interracial relationships could also be related to these disparities.

A recent meta-analysis of 28 studies consisting of 16,987 individuals engaged in intraracial relationships and 2,392 individuals in interracial relationships suggests little difference in satisfaction (d = -0.06, [-.17, .05]) (Brooks, 2021). However, there was a moderate degree of heterogeneity (I = 55.36 %) in the samples, indicating that variance in the effect sizes was partially due to moderators. The only variable explored that reached statistical significance out of 16 was region, with national samples yielding a lower effect size (d = -0.14) than those in the South or Northeast (d = 0.40) (p < .05). It is possible that this is because one of the national samples was a large (N = 5,940), high-quality probability sample (Hohmann-Marriott & Amato, 2008), while the others were small samples from studies that were frequently not even published. Alternatively, it could be a simple statistical fluke derived from doing too many significance tests.

The evidence from the national sample suggests that Black women in interracial relationships experienced less satisfaction (p < .001) and more conflict (p < .001), and those involving Black men experienced more conflict (p < .01) (Hohmann-Marriott & Amato, 2008). This finding did not replicate for Hispanics or individuals of other races.

Different patterns emerge when interracial marriages are evaluated by the specific race combinations. Marriages between Blacks and Whites are more likely to end in divorce, marriages between Whites and Hispanics are slightly more likely to end in divorce, and marriages between Asians and Whites are less likely to end in divorce than marriages between Whites (Y. Zhang & Van Hook, 2009). After controlling

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for marriage cohort, age difference between spouses, region, wife's age at marriage, education, number of children and citizenship status, multiracial pairings involving a Black spouse were more likely to get divorced, and those involving an Asian spouse were less likely to get divorced. This is consistent with the main effects of race, where Blacks are more likely to get divorced than Whites, and Asians are less likely to get divorced than Whites.

Most research suggests that interracial couples are more likely to divorce beyond the influence of the main effects of race (Bratter & King, 2008; Fu, 2000; Kreider, 2000; Wang et al., 2006), even when controlling for covariates like education or religion. This could be caused by many different things: the inherent incompatibility of the races, social pressure, or a selection effect where the same psychological characteristics that make getting into an interracial relationship more likely also increase the likelihood of getting divorced.

There is also evidence of race/sex interactions in divorce rates for interracial couples. Interracial couples of Black men and White women tend to get divorced more often than couples of Black women and White men. Given that women tend to initiate about 70 % of divorces (Friedman & Percival, 1976; Rosenfeld, 2018), perhaps the variance in relationship dissolution is more easily explained by the husband's characteristics rather than the wife's.

Other evidence may suggest the existence of race/sex interactions in other ethnic pairs as well (Fu, 2000). While interracial couples tended to get divorced more often beyond the main effect, there were a few exceptions to this: marriages between a Japanese husband and Hawaiian wife; White husband and Filipino wife; and White husband and Japanese wife were less likely to end in divorce controlling for education, age at marriage, and order of marriage. Given the sample size was very large, all of these differences are significant at the .001 level. Marriages between a Hawaiian wife and White husband were as likely to end in divorce as marriages between two Whites (OR = 0.999).

Current research hypothesizes that social and economic factors are prominent causes of these discrepancies (Bratter & Eschbach, 2006; Brown et al., 2018; Lewis & Yancey, 1995). Focusing solely on social approval, the approval rating of interracial relationships has increased massively since the 60s, with only 4 % of Americans accepting marriages between Whites and colored people in 1957 but 94 % of them accepting marriages between Whites and Blacks in 2021 (McCarthy, 2021). While it is possible that social desirability responding is playing a role in these changes, it is likely that some of it reflects a genuine difference in attitudes. Data from 2008 suggests that 31 % of White Americans were willing to engage in interracial relationships with Blacks and Asians, while 29 % of them weren't willing to at all — indicating that at least some of them are likely to be honest in their position on interracial marriage (Herman & Campbell, 2012).

In addition, it is not appropriate to think of differences in social status or the environment as differences that are caused purely by environmental factors, as differences in income between Blacks and Whites are explained by intelligence (Hu, 2022; Nyborg & Jensen, 2001), and these racial disparities in intelligence are largely caused by genes (Fuerst et al., 2021; Lasker et al., 2019; Piffer, 2019, 2021). Also, the fact that differences in income and education levels may be statistically linked to marital dissatisfaction or divorce does not mean that these variables cause these outcomes. An alternative explanation for these links could be that income and education are proxies for psychological characteristics such as intelligence (Strenze, 2015) or conscientiousness (Duckworth et al., 2012). Incidentally, one of the largest and highest quality studies on interracial relationships did not find that SES (socioeconomic status) explained the disparity in conflict and satisfaction between interracial and intraracial relationships involving Black partners (Hohmann-Marriott & Amato, 2008). To properly explain the difference between our views and those of other social scientists, we plotted a model of race and divorce that accords with the views of most social scientists in Figure 1, and an alternative model that considers genetic factors in Figure 2.

While some social scientists may think that differences in social status, psychological traits, and divorce between individuals may be caused by genetics, few would be willing to claim that differences in genetics between the races cause racial differences in these outcomes.

There has been some research about characteristics that predict interracial mating. Zhang and Sassler (2019) found that, among White men, those closer to their mother were less likely to engage in

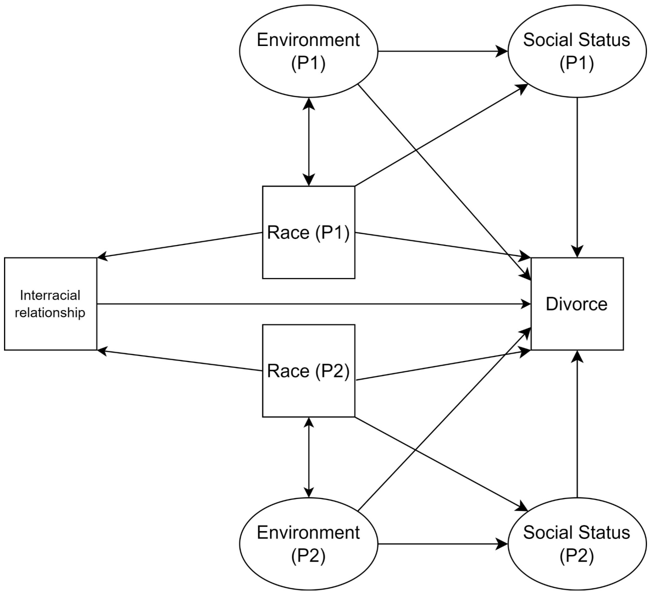

Figure 1: Model of divorce risk based on statements from other researchers. P1 is partner 1, P2 is partner 2.

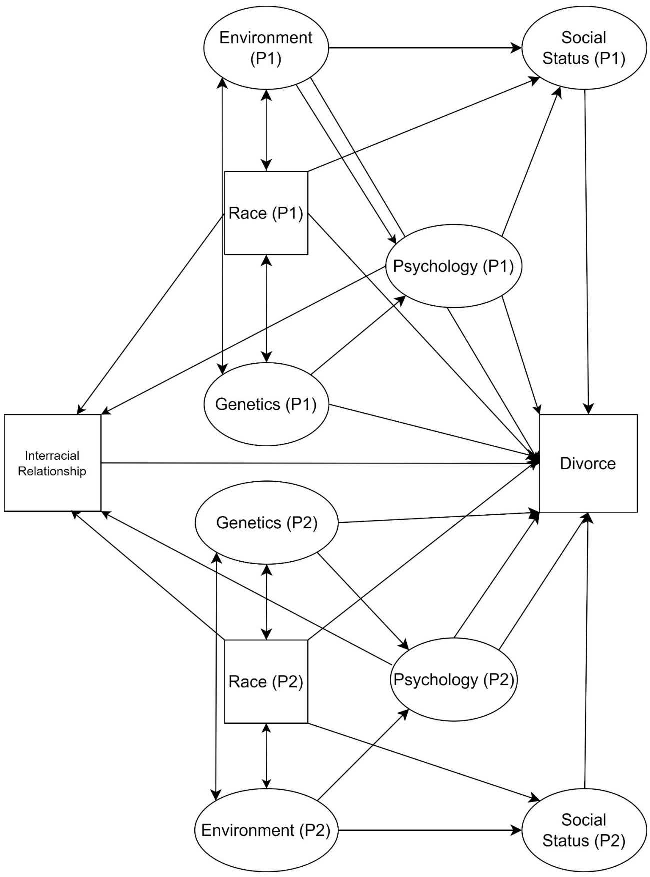

Figure 2: Alternative model that considers genetics and psychological traits. P1 is partner 1, P2 is partner 2.

interracial relationships. Among Blacks and Latinos, higher educational attainment is associated with a greater probability of interracial marriage, while educational attainment is not substantially related to out-marriage among Whites (Mitchell, 2017; Qian, 1997). This is because there is significant assortative mating for education (r = .53) (Horwitz & Keller, 2022), so racial groups lower in educational attainment such as Blacks and Hispanics who out-marry should be expected to be more educated than those who don't.

There has been some research attempting to identify psychological traits and attitudes characteristic of those who are willing to date interracially or those who have done so. One study found that willingness to date interracially was possibly related to self-reported independence (but $p = .03$) and self-reported ability to get one's own way ($p = .001$) (Todd et al., 1992). Race was not controlled for, so it is difficult to know whether this finding would hold up within racial groups. A higher-quality study evaluating the relationship between people's perceptions of racial groups and their likelihood of having dated them found that for both White men and women, the perceived physical attractiveness of racial groups and the perceived social approval of dating those groups were the strongest predictors of having dated those races (Kaplan, 2004). Among White women specifically, a sense of autonomy and efficacy negatively predicted the likelihood of dating Blacks and Hispanics ($p < .05$) and a predisposition to interact with other racial groups also predicted having dated them ($p < .05$).

There is evidence that there is more violence in interracial relationships than in minority and white monoracial couples (both $p < .001$) (Fusco, 2009). It is possible that this is due to psychological differences that cause individuals to form interracial relationships, as this cannot be explained as a main effect of the two races. Multiracial adolescents are also more likely to use drugs than monoracial ones, regardless of the racial comparison group (Choi et al., 2006). In addition, multiracial teenagers were more likely to engage in violent behavior than any of the monoracial groups ($p < .001$ to $p < .05$ depending on the measurement of violence and comparison group). Most of these associations held after controlling for SES, gender, perceived discrimination, and strength of ethnic identity.

There is also an interaction between race and gender in the prevalence of interracial marriages. Black men are much more likely to intermarry than Black women, while Asian women are more likely to intermarry than Asian men (Mitchell, 2017; Y. Zhang & Van Hook, 2009). One possible influence is differences in perceived attractiveness by race (Lewis, 2011, 2012). Women, regardless of race, perceive Black men as the most physically attractive, followed by White men, then Asian men. On the other hand, men, regardless of race, perceive Asian women as the most attractive, followed by White women, then Black women. We were able to replicate that Black women are perceived as less attractive than White women, but not that Black men are more attractive than White men, as shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Race differences in attractiveness by sex (standardized) relative to Whites. * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$, t statistic in parentheses.

Parameter	Difference (women)	Difference (men)
Black	-0.270 (4.7)***	-0.058 (0.9)
Hispanic	0.087 (1.1)	-0.019 (0.2)

Despite the fact that Black men may be perceived as the most attractive, they get the lowest response rates on dating applications (Chow & Hu, 2013; King, 2013). One possible explanation for this paradox is that women perceive Black men as attractive but are dissuaded by the fact that they tend to commit more crimes and earn less money than other men. Rudder (2009) also notes that the rank order of desirability by race as measured by reply rates to messages is White (29.2 %) > Hispanic (23.1 %) > Asian (22.2 %) > Black (21.7 %) > Indian (20.8 %) in men, while in women the rank order is Asian (43.7 %) > Indian (42.7 %) = Hispanic (42.5 %) = White (42.1 %) > Black (34.3 %). Notably, race plays very little of a role in men's preferences for partners, which is also reflected in the self-reports. On average, women report wanting a partner of the same race (46 %) more than men do (34 %), which is true for every race except for Asians, where Asian men and Pacific Islander men ($p = .02$ for the latter) want a same race partner more.

To properly evaluate whether interracial daters are different from other daters, data from the NLSY97 will be used as it has data on both the race of the first sexual partner and current dating partner of the respondent. Variables that are known to have race differences such as intelligence (Lynn, 2006), honesty (Jensen & Kirkegaard, 2023), height and weight (Fryar et al., 2018), parental SES, and emotional difficulties (Banta et al., 2012) have been selected because assortative mating would predict these individuals would be closer to the ethnic group to which they are married or have sex with. We additionally used the Add Health dataset[1], which is a newer quasi-replication of the NLSY datasets to assess the robustness of the findings.

2 Analysis 1: NLSY 1997

2.1 Data

Subjects were from the National Longitudinal Study of Youth (1997), a sample of 8,984 individuals born between 1980 and 1984 who have been surveyed every one to two years. The analysis code is available at `https://rpubs.com/sebjenseb/inter` and the materials are available at `https://osf.io/jdua9/`.

IQ scores were generated by extracting the first general factor from the ASVAB that was administered by the NLSY. This approach has been used previously (Hu, 2022). Age corrections were made to the subtests to avoid confounding the scores with subject age, given that many subjects took the test before the age of 15. These corrections were made using restricted cubic splines, as the relationship between cognitive ability and age is not necessarily linear.

Parental SES was calculated by calculating the first principal component of parental assets, income, and education measured in round 1 (1997) when the youths were about 12-17 years old.

Three methods were used to classify individuals by race. The first is to categorize them using a variable provided by the NLSY staff that was based on household information and the race of the biological parents. If this information was not available, self-reports of social race were taken from the Round 6 (2002) questionnaire. The question and answer key for this item are available in the supplement. If participants were still unclassified, interviewer responses from the Round 5 (2001) questionnaire were used to classify race. The individuals were then grouped into four main categories: White (European American), Hispanic (Latino), Black (African American), and Other (a mix of East Asians, Native Americans, and others). Given the small number and heterogeneity of people placed in the racial category of Other (n = 387), these individuals were not taken into account when analyzing interracial relationships.

Self-reported height and weight were taken from rounds 1 (1997), 2 (1998), 3 (1999), and 4 (2000). A sample of American adults comparing self-reported height/weight to real measurements suggests they are fairly reliable (reliability of self-reported height = 0.95, (reliability of self-reported weight = 0.98) (Hodge et al., 2020). When Malaysian teenagers were asked what their last weight and height measurements were, these corresponded pretty closely to true measurements of height (reliability = .94) and weight (reliability = .96) (Kee et al., 2017). Height and weight measurements were taken from the latest year possible.

These measurements were also standardized relative to the year in question to avoid missing values from the survey years from biasing the height variable. Relative weight was calculated by taking the residual of the respondent's weight controlled for height taking into account a potential interaction with participant sex and age. Both the age and the height controls were done with natural splines, which takes into account non-linear relationships between these variables and weight.

Problematic behaviors of the respondents were assessed in round 1 (1997) by the parents using the Behavioral and Emotional Problems Scale, a 4-item scale compiled by the BLS:

1. (Youth) can't concentrate or pay attention for long.
2. (Youth) doesn't get along with other kids.
3. (Youth) lies or cheats.
4. (Youth) is unhappy, sad or depressed.

There were three answer choices: that it was not true (0), sometimes true (1), or often true (2) during the last six months. These scores were collected separately for girls and boys, and were transformed to z-scores which indicated how problematic their behavior was relative to individuals of their own gender.

For honesty, there were three variables available: self-reported, interviewer-reported, and parent-reported honesty. For self-reported honesty, youth were prompted with the phrase "you lie or cheat",

[1] National Longitudinal Study of Adolescent to Adult Health, `https://addhealth.cpc.unc.edu/`

and were instructed to respond whether this statement was "not true", "somewhat/sometimes true", or "often true". For parent-reported honesty, parents were prompted with the question "[their child] lies or cheats", and were instructed to respond whether this statement was "not true", "somewhat/sometimes true", or "often true". Both the youth and parents were requested to only consider the behavior that had occurred within the last six months. Interviewer-reported honesty was determined based on reports from individual interviewers determined from every wave. At the end of each survey, these interviewers were prompted with the question "In general, how candid/honest was the youth respondent?", and answered 'Very candid/honest' (1), 'Moderately candid/honest' (2), 'Somewhat candid/honest' (3), or 'Not at all candid/honest' (4). These interviewer reports were then averaged into one composite interviewer-reported honesty variable. Then, IRT (item response theory) scores were calculated from the three different reports to determine the respondent's general level of honesty.

Data relating to the race of the respondent's first sexual partner was collected from round 4 (2000) to round 15 (2011), which was based on reports from the respondent. The partners were classified as Black, White, Amerindian, Asian, or Hispanic. Individuals who reported a partner of another race, were not interviewed, or didn't report the race of their partner were excluded. Contradictory reports of the race of the first sexual partner between waves also resulted in exclusion, which happened 53 times.

The number of sexual partners was taken from self-reports from waves 1 onward where individuals reported whether they had ever had sex and how many people they had it with. Values of over 20 were judged to be unreliable and were removed from the dataset.

Data relating to the race of the partners the respondent dated was also recorded between round 6 (2002) and round 15 (2011), much in the same way the race of the first sexual partner was categorized. These partners were classified as Black, White, Hispanic, Amerindian, Asian, or Other. Individuals who refused to respond, didn't know, or were not interviewed were excluded. Then, individuals were grouped depending on whether they had or had not dated an individual of another race. The results of the analysis using dating partners as a measurement are reported in the supplement.

Quantitative continuous variables were standardized to a mean of 0 and a standard deviation of 1 with some exceptions. IQ was standardized relative to a White mean of 100 and White standard deviation of 15. All variables were controlled for sex and age. The justification for controlling for age and sex is to avoid cohort and sex differences in interracial dating from biasing the results. Within the replication which included dating data from several different waves, number of sexual partners was controlled for to avoid the fact that the results are inherently confounded with sociosexuality.

2.2 Results

The strength of the associations depended on the variable and the race. Associations were strongest for Hispanics, then Blacks, then Whites. IQ and parental SES were the strongest predictors across the board, while honesty and skin color were the weakest predictors. Within Whites, IQ (d = -0.22, $p < .001$), parental SES (d = -0.11, $p < .05$), relative weight ($d = 0.25$, $p < .001$), honesty (d = -0.17, $p < .001$), and problematic behavior ($d = 0.28$, $p < .001$) predicted interracial sex. Within Hispanics, IQ ($d = 0.74$, $p < .001$), parental SES ($d = 0.64$, $p < .001$), honesty ($d = 0.16$, $p < .01$), and height ($d = 0.32$, $p < .001$) predicted the frequency of interracial dating. Within Blacks, IQ ($d = 0.30$, $p < .001$), parental SES ($d = 0.24$, $p < .01$), and honesty ($d = 0.15$, $p < .05$) predicted the proportion of partners of another race. Figures 3 to 9 graphically display these results (using a logistic model with one predictor), and Table 2 shows the strength of these particular relationships by race.

Logistic regression was used to determine if any of the associations displayed with interracial dating could potentially be products of associations of other variables. About half of the associations that reached statistical significance in the univariate analysis reached significance also in the multivariate analysis, as shown in Tables 3-5.

Table 2: Standardized difference (Cohen's d) in each variable between individuals who had a first sexual partner of another race and those who didn't. * p < .05, ** p < .01, *** p < .001. Sample size in parentheses.

Parameter	White	Hispanic	Black
IQ	-0.22 (n = 3167)***	0.74 (n = 1040)***	0.30 (n = 1519)***
Parental SES	-0.11 (n = 3843)*	0.64 (n = 1435)***	0.24 (n = 1955)***
Honesty	-0.17 (n = 3843)***	0.16 (n = 1435)**	0.15 (n = 1955)*
Problematic behavior	0.28 (n = 1486)***	-0.12 (n = 507)	-0.10 (n = 698)
Relative weight	0.25 (n = 3833)***	-0.03 (n = 1427)	0.00 (n = 1952)
Height	0.04 (n = 3843)	0.32 (n = 1429)***	0.09 (n = 1955)
Number of sexual partners	0.23 (n = 563)*	0.35 (n = 245)*	-0.14 (n = 529)
Skin color	0.14 (n = 2928)*	-0.05 (n = 1135)	-0.12 (n = 1612)

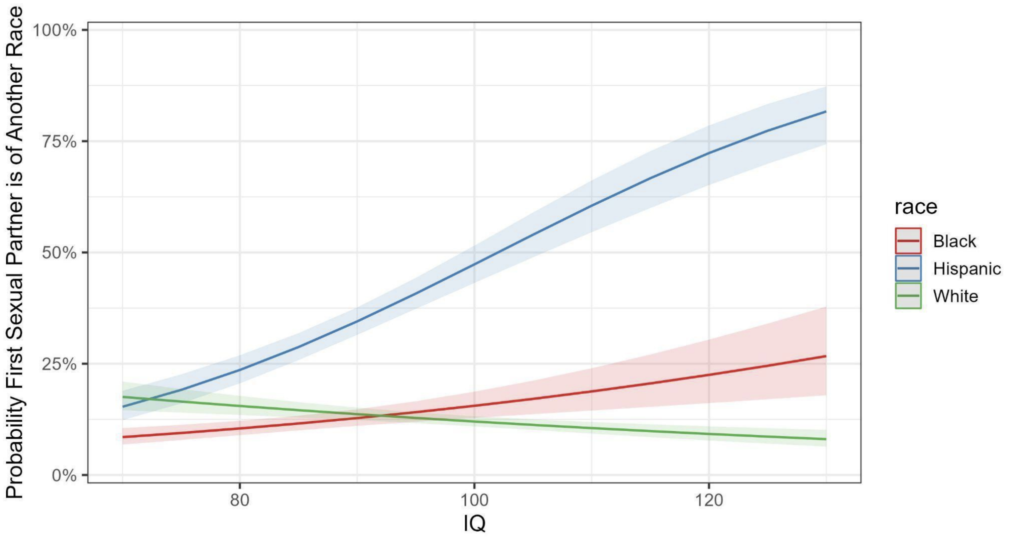

Figure 3: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and intelligence.

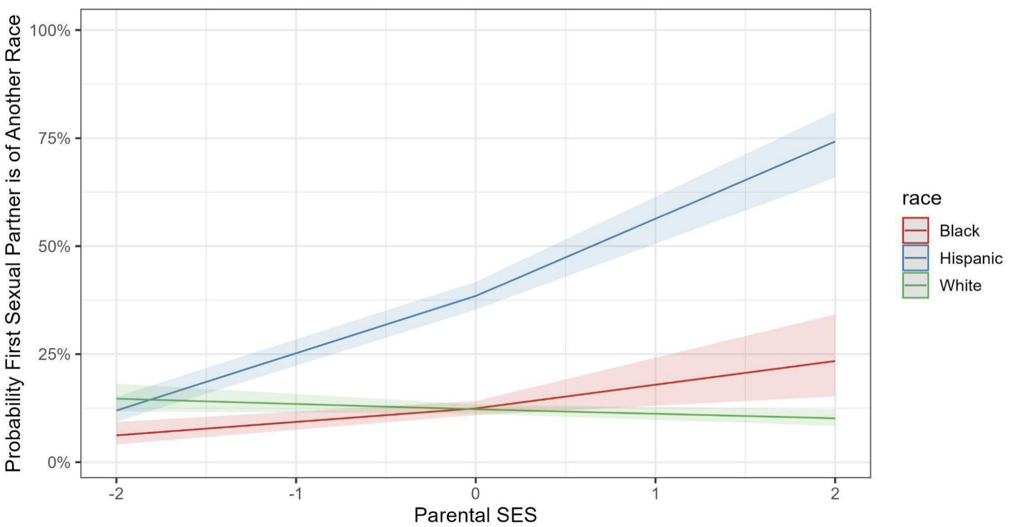

Figure 4: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and parental SES.

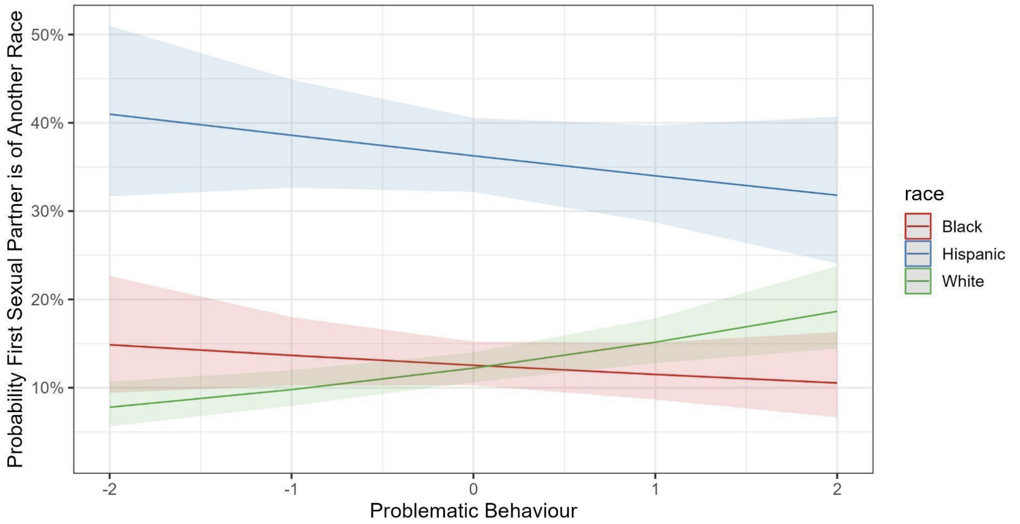

Figure 5: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and problematic behavior.

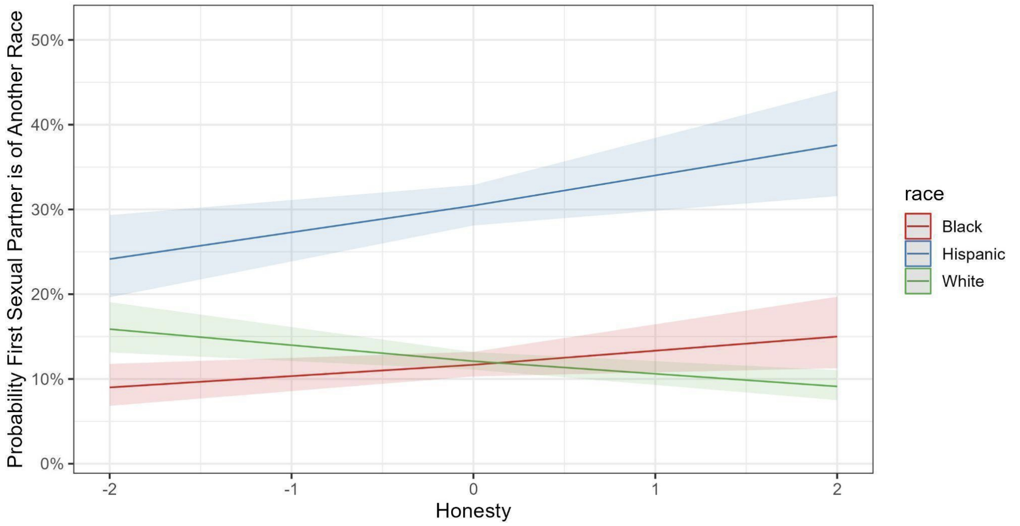

Figure 6: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and honesty.

3 Analysis 2: Add Health

3.1 Data

Data was taken from waves 1, 2, 3, and 4 of the National Longitudinal Study of Adolescent to Adult Health (Add Health) dataset. This consists of a core sample of 12,105 teenagers interviewed in grades 7-12 during the 1994-95 school year who were then followed up in 1996 (wave 2), 2001-2002 (wave 3), 2008 (wave 4), and 2016-2018 (wave 5). The analysis code is available at https://rpubs.com/sebjenseb/addhealth.

Data on the race of the respondent's current or last romantic or sexual partner was collected from waves 3 and 4. These partners were then classified as White, Black, Asian, Amerindian, Hispanic or Other based on the reports of the respondent. Data on the race of the respondent was collected in waves 1 and 3. Individuals could report that they were any combination of White, Black, Amerindian, Asian, or Other. These individuals were then classified as White, Black, or Hispanic depending on their responses. Mixed-race, Asian and Amerindian individuals were excluded due to small sample sizes.

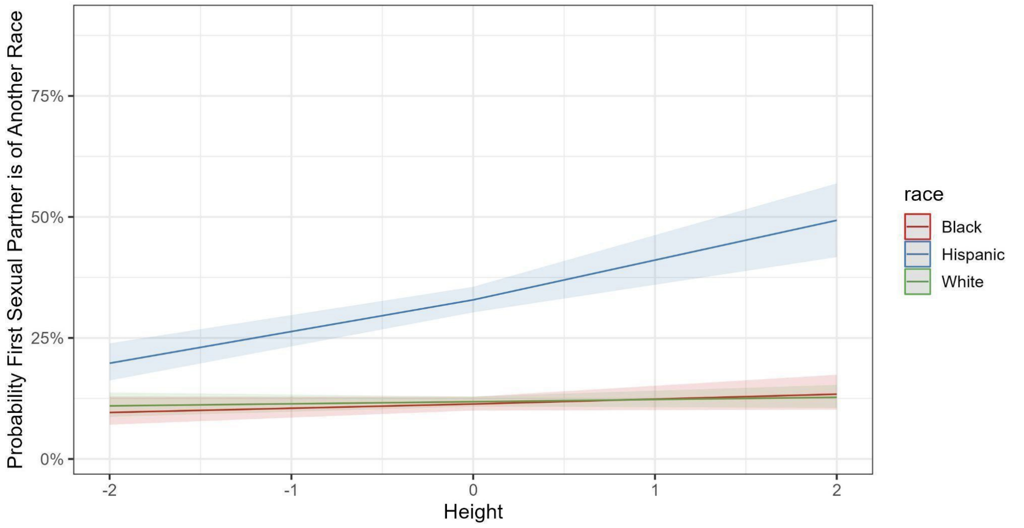

Figure 7: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and height.

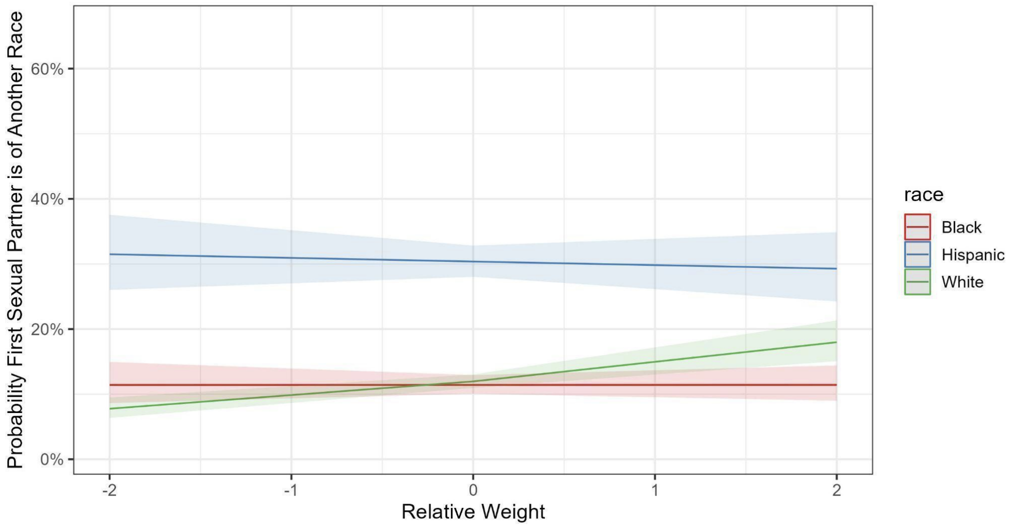

Figure 8: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and relative weight.

The Add Health Picture Vocabulary Test scores were taken from waves 1 and 3. This is a computerized adaptation of the Peabody Picture Vocabulary Test—Revised (Carolina Population Center, n.d.), which consists of 87 questions asking which one of the four pictures the prompted word best describes. The raw scores were standardized by age by default, and individuals with z-scores below -3 were winsorized at -3. These measurements were then averaged for more accurate measurements.

Data on the parents' education levels were taken from wave 1. When the educational attainment of one parent was not available, data from the other parent was used. These are used as a proxy for socioeconomic status, which had been found to be related to an individual's likelihood of having a partner of another race in the NLSY analysis.

Data regarding impulsive behavior of the adolescents was sampled in waves 3 and 4. This was sampled using a self-report questionnaire which asked individuals questions such as "I sometimes get so excited that I lose control of myself", which individuals answered on a 5-point Likert scale of agreement. Items that overlapped too much with Machiavellianism such as "How true do you think the following statement is of you? I can usually get people to believe me, even when what I'm saying isn't quite true." were excluded. A

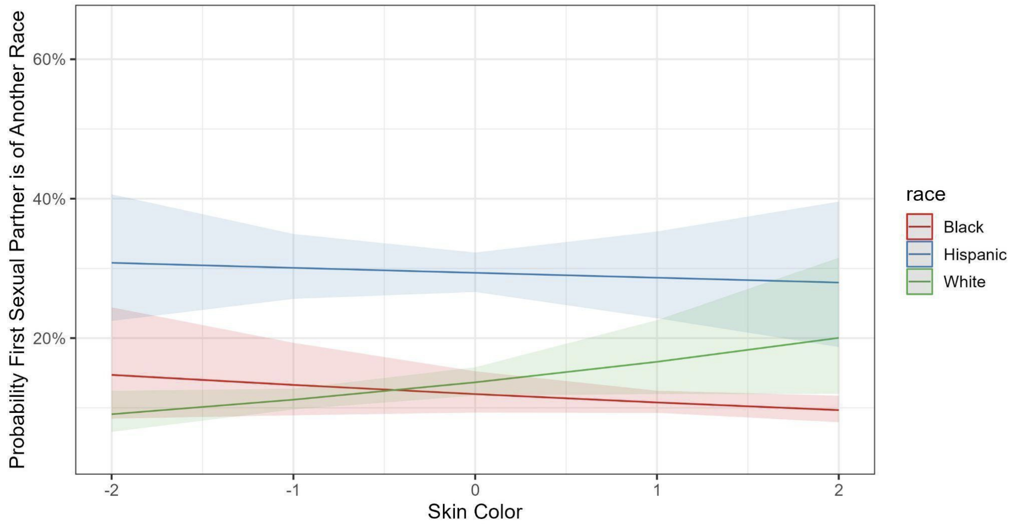

Figure 9: Predicted probability of first sexual partner being of another race depending on race and skin color.

Table 3: Logistic regression models predicting interracial sex within Whites. * p < .05, ** p < .01, *** p < .001, *t* statistic in parentheses.

Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4	Model 5	Model 6	Model 7
IQ	-0.20 (3.1)**	-0.12 (1.2)	-0.21 (3.4)***	-0.21 (3.1)**	-0.23 (3.7)***		-0.01 (0.1)
Parental SES	-0.10 (1.6)						-0.10 (0.9)
Problematic behavior		0.23 (2.7)**				0.22 (2.7)**	0.20 (1.9)
Honesty			-0.12 (2.2)*			-0.06 (0.8)	-0.07 (0.8)
Skin color				0.21 (1.5)			0.22 (1.0)
Relative weight					0.25 (4.5)***	0.23 (2.8)**	0.27 (2.9)**
Sample size	3167	1241	3167	2454	3158	1481	955

Table 4: Logistic regression models predicting interracial sex within Hispanics. * p < .05, ** p < .01, *** p < .001, *t* statistic in parentheses.

Parameter	White	Hispanic	Black		
Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4	Model 5
IQ	0.74 (7.7)***	0.89 (9.8)***	0.87 (9.2)***	0.70 (7.0)***	0.68 (7.0)***
Parental SES	0.51 (5.5)***			0.49 (5.4)***	0.49 (5.3)***
Honesty		0.11 (1.5)			0.14 (1.8)
Height			0.28 (3.7)***	0.28 (3.5)***	0.28 (3.5)***
Sample size	1040	1040	1035	1044	1033

Table 5: Logistic regression models predicting interracial sex within Blacks. * p < .05, ** p < .01, *** p < .001, *t* statistic in parentheses.

Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
IQ	0.29 (2.9)**	0.33 (3.3)***	0.27 (2.6)*
Parental SES	0.25 (1.7)		0.25 (1.7)
Honesty		0.08 (1.0)	0.08 (0.9)
Sample size	1519	1519	1518

score of impulsivity was created using 9 questions from the dataset.

Data on the individual's personality characteristics were taken from a set of 41 questions that were asked in wave 4, in a similar fashion to how questions regarding impulsivity were asked. Identifying which questions loaded onto which factors was done by consulting the Big-Five Factor Markers (n.d.) from the IPIP website. These questions then generated a measurement of Conscientiousness, Agreeableness, Neuroticism, Extraversion, and Openness.

A first general factor was also extracted from the five personality variables to measure the general factor of personality (GFP). In addition, the number of sexual partners, number of diagnosed mental illnesses, drug use, criminality, and impulsivity of a person was combined into one general risk-taking measurement. The specific questions associated with every personality factor are reported in the supplement. The reliabilities of the personality constructs in addition to other variables are displayed in Table 6. Only the impulsivity measure from wave 3, the measure of drug use from wave 3, and the neuroticism measure from wave 4 were highly reliable. The low reliability of the measurement of mental illnesses is due to the small number of illnesses that were considered (ADHD, PTSD, anxiety, depression). Reliabilities were assessed based on the empirical reliability function in the 'mirt' package from R (Chalmers, 2023), and the reliability of risk-taking behavior was assessed using the omega reliability coefficient (Revelle, 2023).

Table 6: Reliability of psychological trait measurements.

Trait	Reliability
Trait	Reliability
Impulsivity (wave 3/4)	0.87
Extroversion (wave 4)	0.76
Openness (wave 4)	0.71
Agreeableness (wave 4)	0.73
Neuroticism (wave 4)	0.89
Mental illness	0.46
Drug use	0.85
Risk-taking behavior	0.59
Conscientiousness (wave 4)	0.70

Height and weight of the subjects were assessed in rounds 3 and 4. Where these measurements were missing because they were invalid or the participants refused to take them, self-reports were used instead. These measurements were then controlled for age to avoid age differences in height and weight from biasing the results. Then the relative weight was calculated by taking the residual of weight controlled for a three-way interaction of age, sex, and height. This functions similarly to BMI, but is a more precisely calculated measurement.

Measurements of physical attractiveness were taken from interviewer reports from waves 1, 2, 3, and 4. The first general factor of attractiveness was extracted from these reports to increase the reliability of the metric, as these ratings differed heavily depending on the rater, given that the correlation between attractiveness ratings in waves 3 and 4 was only .16.

Drug use was measured by taking into account whether an individual had used alcohol, cocaine, methamphetamine, tobacco, marijuana, or any other drug in the past year according to self-reports from wave 3. IRT (item response theory) was then used to calculate an individual's general predisposition to use drugs. This method of calculating drug use is unusual, but it was done for two main reasons. First, the use of certain drugs (cocaine and methamphetamine in particular) is not normally distributed; and second, some drugs could serve as better measurements of an individual's general predisposition to drug use. This latent factor was reasonably reliable (r_{xx} = .85).

The quantity of diagnosed mental illnesses in wave 4 was also measured based on self-reports of diagnosed depression, anxiety, PTSD, and ADHD as well as whether they had attended psychological counseling in the last 12 months. This measure had a very low reliability (r_{xx} = .48). Given that measurements of psychopathology tend to intercorrelate, this measures an individual's latent predisposition to psychopathology, also known as the p-factor. Like in the case of drug use, IRT was used to calculate the factor scores assuming that some mental illnesses may be better measurements of an individual's predisposition to mental illness than others.

The number of sexual partners was measured based on self-reports from wave 3. Individuals who reported more than 20 sex partners were removed from the dataset, as values above that number were judged to be unreliable.

All quantitative variables were standardized to a mean of 0 and standard deviation of 1. Two exceptions to this were that vocabulary score was standardized with respect to the White mean, and that the number of sexual partners was not standardized or adjusted for age/sex in the plot to avoid any confusions that may arise. Controls for age and sex were applied, though given only 2 waves of data were used for measurement, controls for the number of sex partners were judged to be unnecessary. Empirically, the difference in sociosexuality between endogamous and interracial daters before and after combining waves was negligible, as displayed in Table 7.

Table 7: Difference in number of sex partners between interracial and endogamous daters by race and method (not adjusted for age and sex). * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$.

Race	Cohen's d(wave 4 only)	Cohen's d(wave 4 and 3)
White	0.10	0.17**
Black	0.36**	0.29**
Hispanic	0.35**	0.41***

3.2 Results

Most of the results from the analysis of the NLSY replicated in the Add Health dataset. The details as to which ones did and did not are available in the supplement. The meta-analytic results from both waves are available in Table 8. In addition, it was found that substantial differences in risk-taking behavior were present between interracial and intraracial couples. Whites who dated outside their race engaged in more risk-taking behavior (d = 0.16, $p < .01$), as did Blacks (d = 0.29, $p < .01$), and Hispanics (d = 0.36, $p < .01$). In addition, it was found that Hispanics who were born in the USA (OR = 3.36) and spoke English at home (OR = 4.36) were much more likely to date interracially.

Due to the low reliability of the measurements of risk taking and general factor of personality, structural equation models (SEM) were used to adjust for measurement error. Structure after measurement models (SAM) was also considered as an alternative estimation method, but yielded effect sizes almost identical to those found in SEM models. The effect sizes generated from SEM estimation are displayed in Table 9, and the effect sizes generated from the structure after measurement models are available in the supplementary materials.

Table 8: Meta-analytic results from both datasets. * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$.

Parameter	White	Black	Hispanic
IQ	-0.22 (n = 5196)***	0.31 (n = 2143)***	0.73 (n = 1329)***
Parental SES	0.07 (n = 6037)*	0.21 (n = 2633)***	0.66 (n = 1737)***
Relative weight	0.16 (n = 6027)***	-0.06 (n = 2630)	-0.03 (n = 1729)
Height	0.05 (n = 5830)	0.06 (n = 2633)	0.28 (n = 1731)***
Number of sex partners	0.19 (n = 2757)*	0.06 (n = 1207)	0.39 (n = 547)***

Table 9: Standardized differences in risk taking and general factor of personality between interracial and endogamous daters by race. Positive values indicate interracial daters are higher. Latent difference modeled with structural equation model.

		Cohen's d				
Race	Trait	SEM difference	Raw difference	CFI	RMSEA	SRMR
White	Risk-taking	0.18, p = .01	0.16, p <.01	0.97	0.035	0.024
Hispanic	Risk-taking	0.54, p <.001	0.36, p <.01	0.92	0.064	0.050
Black	Risk-taking	0.39, p <.01	0.35, p <.001	0.97	0.031	0.028
White	GFP	0.02, p = .75	0.01, p = .89	0.91	0.057	0.036
Hispanic	GFP	0.38, p = .023	0.32, p <.01	1.00	0.000	0.025
Black	GFP	0.28, p = .027	0.23, p = .017	0.95	0.051	0.035

Logistic regression was used to determine if any of the associations displayed with interracial dating could potentially be products of associations of other variables. It is worth noting that a variable no longer being significant in a regression model does not indicate an absence of causality for several reasons. First of all, many of the variables in the models are measuring similar things in different ways, for instance, drug use and impulsivity correlated within this dataset ($r = .27$, $p < .001$), and drug use itself acts as a covert measure of impulsive or risky behavior. Second, the sample size of interracial daters is not great, particularly within Blacks, so it is difficult to ascertain whether a variable failing to reach significance reflects an absence of a difference or a type II error.

Because of this, covariates were chosen based on what reached statistical significance in the meta-analysis or were strong predictors of behavior within this dataset. For Hispanics, these were 'speaking English at home', 'height', 'vocabulary score', and 'parental education'. For Blacks, only 'vocabulary score' was chosen as a potential covariate, as parental education was not a robust predictor of interracial dating within this dataset ($d = 0.13$, $p = .20$). For Whites, only vocabulary score was chosen as well, as parental education was also not a robust predictor of interracial dating ($d = 0.012$, $p = .83$). Several other regression methods were attempted earlier in the development of this study which were deemed uninformative, but for the purpose of honesty they have been placed into the supplement.

The results of the logistic regression models in Table 10 suggest that most variables that are predictors in univariate models are also predictors in multivariate models. The one exception to this appears to be risk-taking in Hispanics ($\beta = 0.20$, $p = .12$), though this seems to be expected, as controlling for variables will reduce the power.

In addition, the aggregate differences in intelligence by race/sex/partner race combination were calculated from two different data sources (NLSY97, Add Health wave 4). The reason why wave 3 was not considered is that including it in the averages would result in a violation of statistical independence. The results from the investigation of interactions mirror those of the separate analyses (Table 11 and Figure 10). Failures to detect differences are likely to be power failures due to small sample sizes.

Table 10: Logistic regression models predicting interracial dating within Whites, Blacks, and Hispanics.

Parameter	Within Whites	Within Blacks	Within Hispanics
Vocabulary score	-0.23 (3.4)***	0.25 (2.4)*	0.38 (2.8)**
Risk-taking	0.17 (3.0)**	0.28 (2.5)*	0.21 (1.6)
Height			-0.09 (0.6)
Parental education			0.39 (3.0)**
Speak English at home			0.79 (2.8)**

Table 11: Average IQ by combination of respondent sex, race, and race of partner.

Race	Race of partner	Sex	Average IQ	Sample size	p
White	White	Female	99.7	2304	
White	Black	Female	93.1	113	<.001
White	Hispanic	Female	97.0	188	<.01
White	Uncertain	Female	97.9	289	<.05
White	White	Male	101.1	2278	
White	Black	Male	96.6	32	<.05
White	Hispanic	Male	96.1	145	<.001
White	Uncertain	Male	101.4	300	.71
Black	White	Female	94.9	43	<.001
Black	Black	Female	85.0	1113	
Black	Hispanic	Female	90.8	22	.083
Black	Uncertain	Female	85.9	144	.57
Black	White	Male	88.9	114	<.001
Black	Black	Male	83.4	771	
Black	Hispanic	Male	89.8	52	<.01
Black	Uncertain	Male	83.4	190	1
Hispanic	White	Female	95.3	168	<.001
Hispanic	Black	Female	89.1	39	.086
Hispanic	Hispanic	Female	85.1	451	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Female	88.3	136	<.05
Hispanic	White	Male	95.7	200	<.001
Hispanic	Black	Male	93.0	19	<.05
Hispanic	Hispanic	Male	86.2	411	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Male	87.7	152	.24

4 Discussion

The results suggest that assortative mating applies between races as well as within races. Within Whites, higher intelligence is associated with lower rates of interracial dating, while within Blacks and Hispanics higher intelligence is associated with higher rates of interracial dating. Within Hispanics, parental SES and speaking English at home were both positive predictors of dating interracially. One alternative theory to assortative mating is that people mate assortatively for racial ancestry instead, and that the associations found are merely a product of this. Given that skin color was not a very strong predictor of dating interracially but parental SES and IQ were, this does not seem very likely.

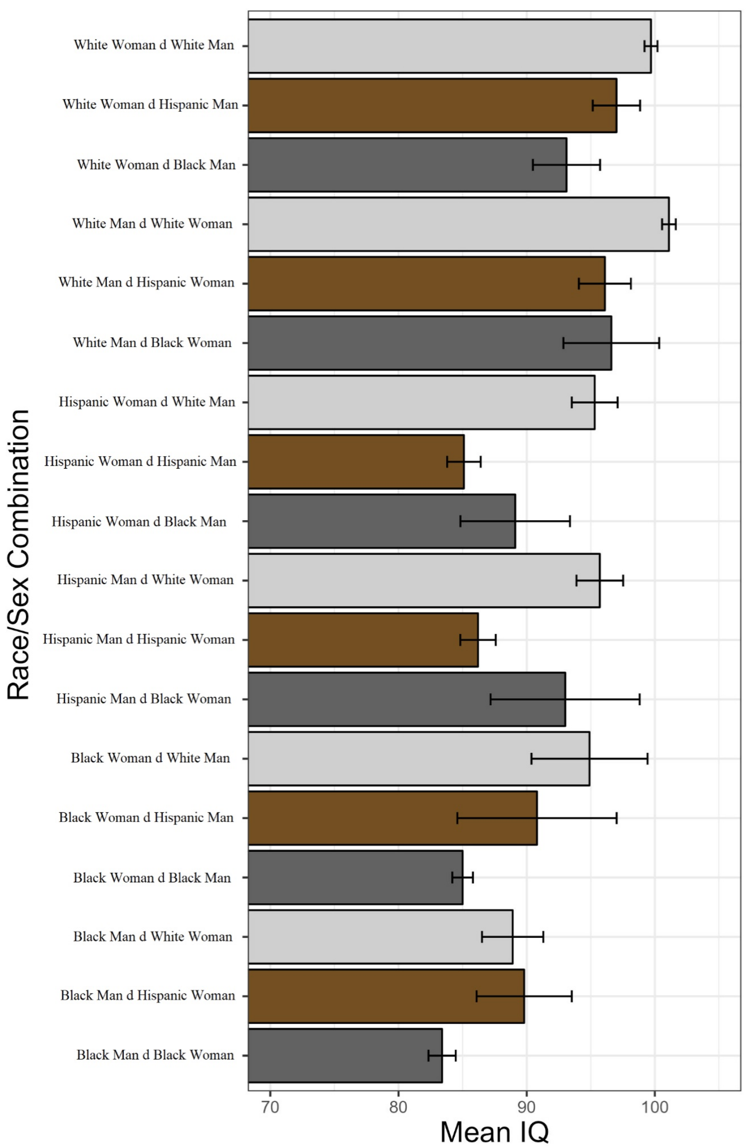

Figure 10: Average IQ by combination of respondent race, sex, and partner race. 95 % confidence intervals are shown in brackets.

While most personality measurements were not predictive of the tendency to date interracially, it is likely that the low reliability of these measurements is affecting their power to detect a true association. Notably, variables that were combinations of several others, such as risk-taking and general factor of personality, were generally more predictive of interracial dating.

There is some suggestive evidence that Whites who date interracially tend to be more overweight, though this finding did not replicate in the Add Health data. In addition, GFP positively predicted the likelihood of interracial dating in Blacks and Hispanics. This could potentially be due to assortative mating in prosociality, which means that Whites who date Blacks/Hispanics tend to be less prosocial while Blacks/Hispanics who date Whites are more prosocial. However, no difference in GFP ($p = .89$) was detected between Whites who dated interracially and those who dated endogamously, though this could be due to a simple power failure.

Individuals who dated outside their race tended to engage in a wide variety of risky behavior such as drug use and criminality regardless of their race. This provides evidence that the violence and drug use observed in mixed-race adolescents and the divorce rate among interracial couples may be influenced by self-selection. This rests on the assumption that impulsivity is heritable, which does seem to be true, as the heritability of impulsivity is between 20 % and 60 % when self-reports of impulsivity are examined (Niv et al., 2011; Tiego et al., 2020). Given that the heritabilities of personality traits are about 40-50 % when self-report measures are used (Bouchard, 2004; Vukasović & Bratko, 2015) but 60-96 % when self- and peer-reports are combined (Baker et al., 2007; Riemann & Kandler, 2010), it is likely that impulsivity would have a similarly high actual heritability.

If impulsivity is heritable, then it is expected that the parents of mixed-race children pass on their genes associated with high impulsivity to their children. This is substantiated by observations that mixed-race children engage in more risky behavior such as drug use and violence than can be attributed to the main effects of the races or environmental variables (Choi et al., 2006; Fusco, 2009). Figure 11 summarizes this theory graphically.

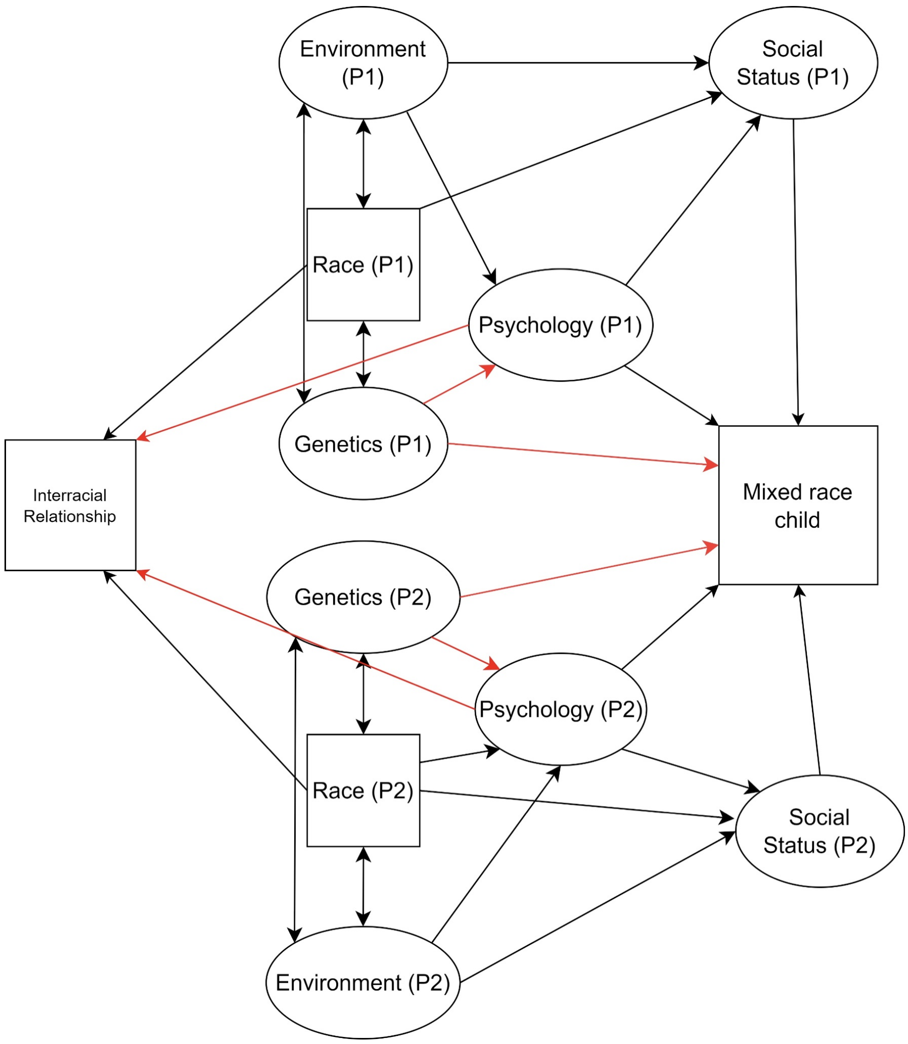

Figure 11: Diagram of the genetic theory of impulsive mixed-race adolescents. The genetic paths are hypothesized to be the largest, while the psychological paths/social status paths are hypothesized to be null. The paths in red are the ones that are most relevant to the theory.

Multiracial children use drugs more often than monoracial children (d = 0.2) (Choi et al., 2006), though it is difficult to compute the effect size exactly due to the kind of the data. In our study, the average effect size between interracial daters and endogamous daters was 0.25 ((0.1+0.31+0.35)/3). This indicates that the drug use of mixed-race individuals is roughly in line with what would be expected from genetic transmission theory.

More research is needed to determine whether differences in these psychological characteristics and behaviors can account for most or all of the difference in divorce risk between endogamous and interracial couples. Based on priors, it would be expected that they can account for some of it, but it is difficult to determine at the moment. This could be researched using a study that assesses the divorce risk of interracial couples accounting for the main effect of race in addition to their personalities, though this would be difficult to do. When too many variables are controlled for, this decreases the ability to detect an effect. When not enough variables are controlled for, interracial dating itself may act as a proxy for the unmeasured as well as any incorrectly measured psychological traits.

While the current literature surrounding mixed-race marriages mostly seems to support that disparities between interracial and endogamous marriages are associated with the main effects of each racial group, there is some literature supporting the view that interracial marriages (Fu, 2000) and relationships (Wang et al., 2006) dissolve more commonly than what would be expected solely based on a main effects analysis. If it is true that interracial relationships or marriages dissolve more frequently than what would be expected from the main effects of each race, then it is probable that this is because individuals who tend to date interracially tend to be higher in impulsivity and sensation seeking.

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Appendix

A First Appendix

Table A1: Question and answer key for Round 6 question asking the individual what his race is.

Question:	Which one of the following are you?
Answer 1	White
Answer 2	Black or African American
Answer 3	American Indian, Eskimo, or Aleut
Answer 4	Asian or Pacific Islander
Answer 5	Something Else? (Specify)
Answer 6	R Refuses to classify race except hispanic/latino

Table A2: Questions for the wave 3 measurement of impulsivity.

Question Number	How true do you think the following statement is of you?...
Q1	"I often try new things just for fun or thrills, even if most people think they are a waste of time."
Q2	"When nothing new is happening, I usually start looking for something exciting."
Q3	"I often do things based on how I feel at the moment."
Q4	"I sometimes get so excited that I lose control of myself."
Q5	"I like it when people can do whatever they want, without strict rules and regulations."
Q6	"I often follow my instincts, without thinking through all the details."
Q7	"I change my interest a lot, because my attention often shifts to something else."

Table A3: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of extroversion.

Question Number	How much do you agree with each statement about you as you generally are now, not as you wish to be in the future?...
Q1	"I am the life of the party."
Q2	"I don't talk a lot."
Q3	"I talk to a lot of different people at parties."
Q4	"I keep in the background."

Table A4: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of agreeableness.

Question Number	How much do you agree with each statement about you as you generally are now, not as you wish to be in the future?...
Q1	"I sympathize with others' feelings."
Q2	"I am not interested in other people's problems."
Q3	"I feel others' emotions."
Q4	"I am not really interested in others."

Table A5: Metrics used for the wave 3 measurement of drug use.

Metric number	Have you used x drug within y timeframe?
Q1	Alcohol, since 1995 (6-7 years ago)
Q2	Cocaine, since 1995
Q3	Methamphetamine, since 1995
Q4	Tobacco, since 1995
Q5	Marijuana
Q6	Other drugs, since 1995
Q7	Alcohol, at most 1 year ago
Q8	Cocaine, at most 1 year ago
Q9	Methamphetamine, at most 1 year ago
Q10	Tobacco, at most 1 year ago
Q11	Marijuana, at most 1 year ago
Q12	Other drugs, at most 1 year ago

Table A6: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of conscientiousness.

Question Number	How much do you agree with each statement about you as you generally are now, not as you wish to be in the future?...
Q1	"I get chores done right away."
Q2	"I often forget to put things back in their proper place."
Q3	"I like order."
Q4	"I make a mess of things."

Table A7: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of neuroticism.

Question Number	How much do you agree with each statement about you as you generally are now, not as you wish to be in the future?...
Q1	"I have frequent mood swings."
Q2	"I worry about things."
Q3	"I get angry easily"
Q4	"I am relaxed most of the time."
Q5	"I am not easily bothered by things."
Q6	"I rarely get irritated."
Q7	"I get upset easily."
Q8	"I get stressed out easily."
Q9	"I lose my temper."
Q10	"I seldom feel blue."

Table A8: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of openness.

Question Number	How much do you agree with each statement about you as you generally are now, not as you wish to be in the future?...
Q1	"I have a vivid imagination."
Q2	"I have difficulty understanding abstract ideas."
Q3	"I do not have a good imagination."
Q4	"I am not interested in abstract ideas."

Table A9: Questions for the wave 4 measurement of impulsivity.

Question Number	"Do you agree or disagree with the following statement?"
Q1	"When making decisions, you usually go with your "gut feeling" without thinking too much about the consequences of each alternative."
Q2	"You like to take risks."
Q3	"You live your life without much thought for the future."

Table A10: IQ relative to the White mean by combination of race, gender, and race of first sexual partner (NLSY).

Race	Race of first sexual partner	Sex	Average IQ	Sample size	p-value
White	White	Female	99.7	1293	
White	Black	Female	95.2	62	p <.01
White	Hispanic	Female	97.3	131	p >.10
White	Uncertain	Female	97.4	239	p <.05
White	White	Male	101.2	1454	
White	Black	Male	91.2	20	p <.01
White	Hispanic	Male	95.2	100	p <.001
White	Uncertain	Male	100.9	254	p >.10
Black	White	Female	91.4	29	p <.05
Black	Black	Female	84.3	756	
Black	Hispanic	Female	86.5	14	p >.10
Black	Uncertain	Female	85.6	135	p >.10
Black	White	Male	88.2	82	p <.001
Black	Black	Male	82.7	591	
Black	Hispanic	Male	88.3	35	p <.05
Black	Uncertain	Male	81.4	162	p >.10
Hispanic	White	Female	95.1	126	p <.001
Hispanic	Black	Female	90.7	28	p <.01
Hispanic	Hispanic	Female	85.2	351	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Female	88.1	125	p <.05
Hispanic	White	Male	95.4	147	p <.001
Hispanic	Black	Male	92.1	14	p >.10
Hispanic	Hispanic	Male	86.6	333	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Male	86.7	137	p >.10

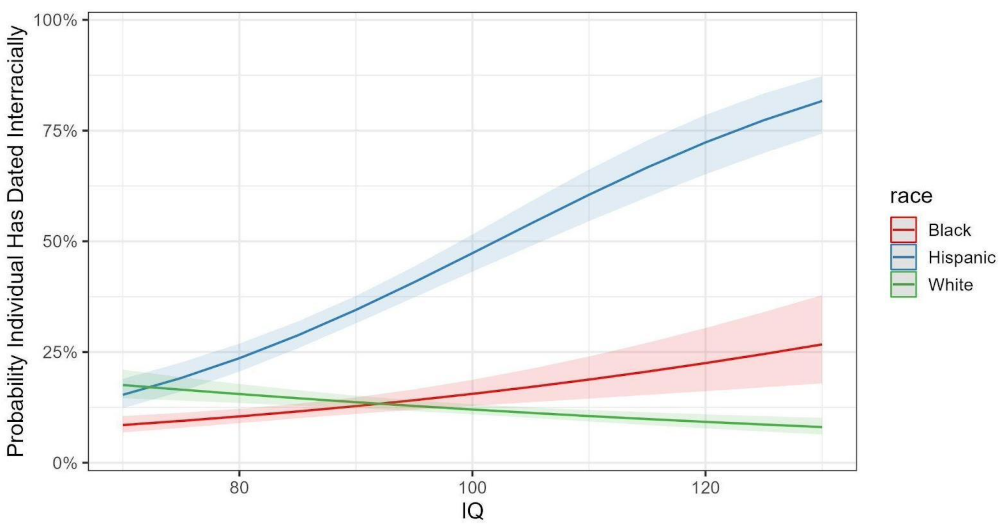

Figure A1: Probability Dating Partner is of Another Race by IQ and Race.

Table A11: Vocabulary score relative to the White mean by combination of race, gender, and race of most recent romantic partner (Add Health wave 3).

Race	Race of romantic partner	Sex	Average IQ	Sample size	p-value
White	White	Female	100.6	1058	
White	Black	Female	93.3	47	$p < .01$
White	Hispanic	Female	96.4	70	$p < .05$
White	Uncertain	Female	95.8	81	$p < .01$
White	White	Male	100.6	878	
White	Black	Male	101	21	$p > .10$
White	Hispanic	Male	95.9	43	$p < .05$
White	Uncertain	Male	103.6	100	$p < .10$
Black	White	Female	88.4	11	$p > .10$
Black	Black	Female	83.8	388	
Black	Hispanic	Female	86.5	9	$p > .10$
Black	Uncertain	Female	85.4	35	$p > .10$
Black	White	Male	90.4	31	$p > .10$
Black	Black	Male	86.7	242	
Black	Hispanic	Male	87.9	17	$p > .10$
Black	Uncertain	Male	83.9	45	$p > .10$
Hispanic	White	Female	96.6	43	$p < .001$
Hispanic	Black	Female	88	12	$p > .10$
Hispanic	Hispanic	Female	85.2	109	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Female	86.9	26	$p > .10$
Hispanic	White	Male	97.4	47	$p < .001$
Hispanic	Black	Male	92.6	5	$p > .10$
Hispanic	Hispanic	Male	84.3	110	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Male	92.9	21	$p < .05$

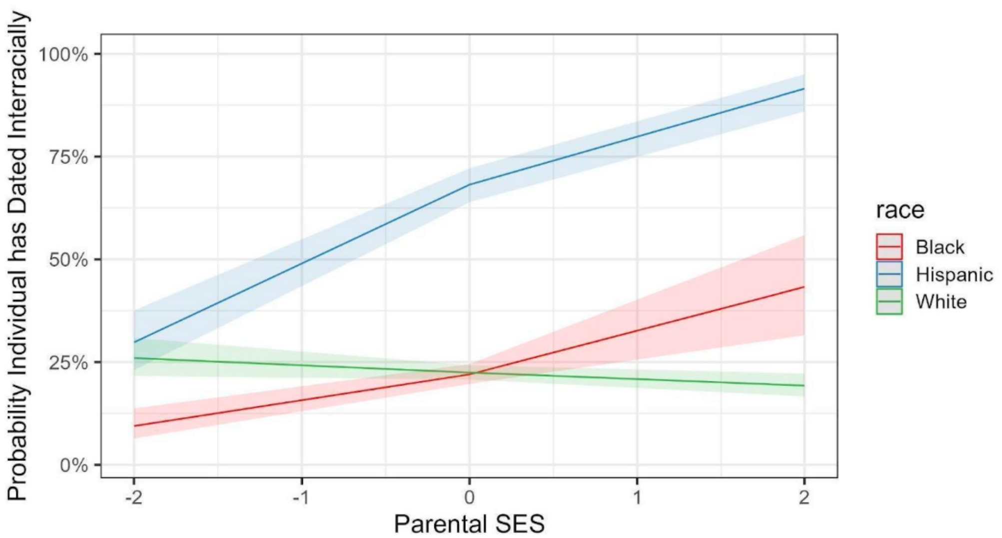

Figure A2: Proportion of dating partners of another race by parental SES and race.

Table A12: Vocabulary score relative to the White mean by combination of race, gender, and race of most recent romantic partner (Add Health wave 4).

Race	Race of romantic partner	Sex	Average IQ	Sample size	p-value
White	White	Female	99.6	1156	
White	Black	Female	90.9	46	p <.001
White	Hispanic	Female	97.2	63	p <.10
White	Uncertain	Female	101.1	44	p >.10
White	White	Male	101	921	
White	Black	Male	103.2	13	p >.10
White	Hispanic	Male	97.6	62	p <.05
White	Uncertain	Male	102.9	54	p <.10
Black	White	Female	101.7	15	p <.001
Black	Black	Female	86.3	449	
Black	Hispanic	Female	87.7	10	p >.10
Black	Uncertain	Female	72.7	13	p <.05
Black	White	Male	88.4	33	p >.10
Black	Black	Male	86.4	257	
Black	Hispanic	Male	93.8	23	p <.05
Black	Uncertain	Male	97.2	28	p <.001
Hispanic	White	Female	96.6	45	p <.001
Hispanic	Black	Female	83.7	10	p >.10
Hispanic	Hispanic	Female	85.2	117	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Female	91.4	11	p >.10
Hispanic	White	Male	96	54	p <.001
Hispanic	Black	Male	89.3	5	p >.10
Hispanic	Hispanic	Male	84.1	99	
Hispanic	Uncertain	Male	98.3	12	p <.001

Table A13: Standardized difference in each variable between those who have and have not dated interracially. Measured in standardized beta. . *** -> p < .001, ** -> p < .01, * -> p < .05. Sample size in parenthesis.

Parameter	White	Hispanic	Black
IQ	-0.07 (2138)	0.44 (570)***	0.46 (1058)***
Parental SES	-0.097 (2549)*	0.56 (763)***	0.31 (1366)***
Honesty	0.0037 (2549)	0.04 (763)	0.15 (1366)*
Problematic Behaviour	0.075 (1130)	0.090 (315)	-0.088 (536)
Relative Weight	0.15 (2543)**	-0.078 (761)	-0.12 (1363)
Height	0.028 (2549)	0.29 (761)***	0.049 (1366)
Skin Color	0.053 (1981)	-0.18 (630)*	-0.17 (1165)*

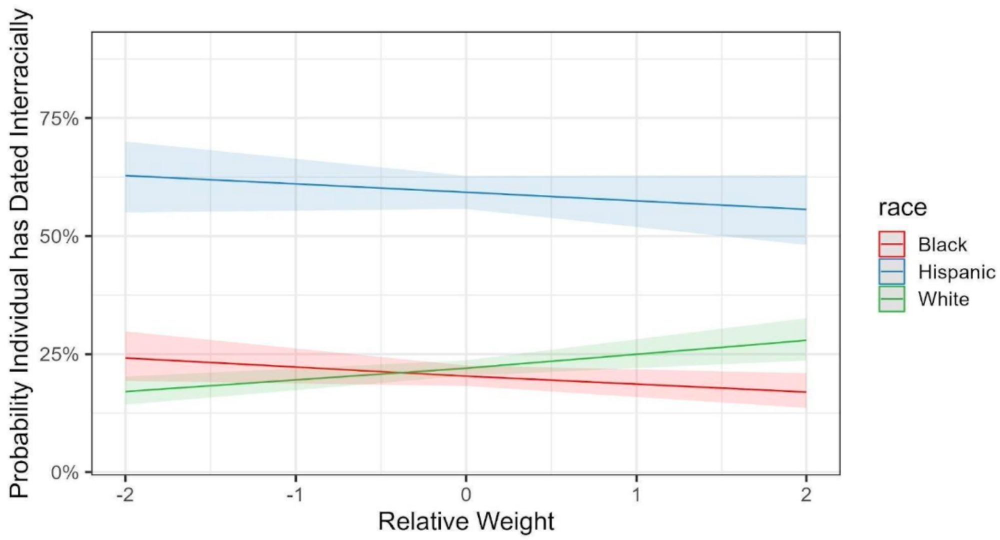

Figure A3: Proportion of dating partners of another race by relative weight and race.

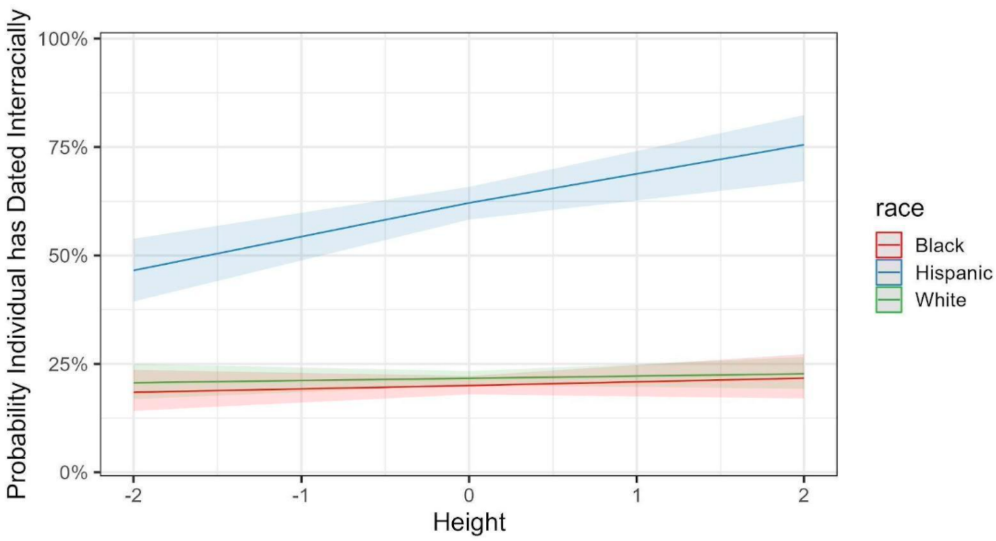

Figure A4: Proportion of dating partners of another race by height and race.

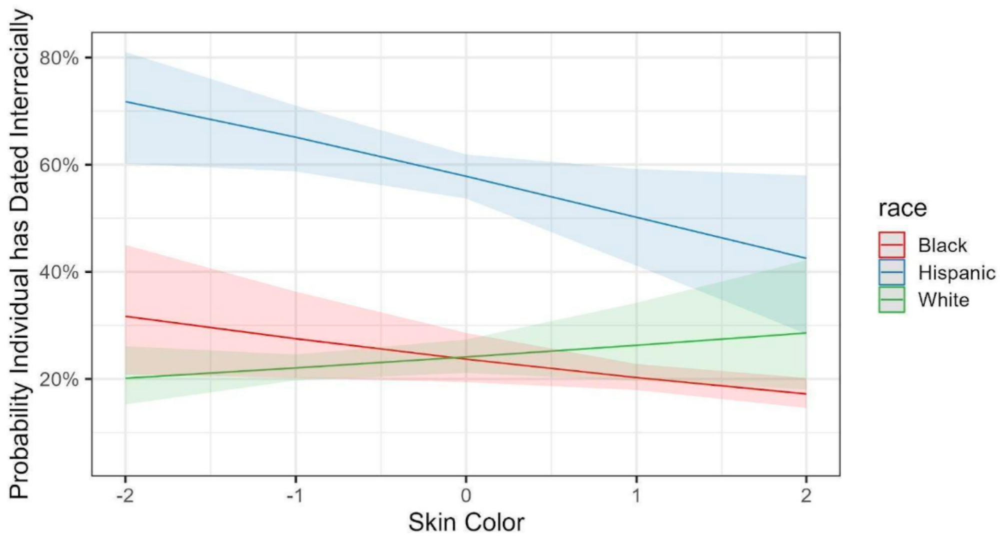

Figure A5: Proportion of dating partners of another race by skin color and race.

Table A14: Regression models predicting whether an individual dated interracially within Whites.

Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
IQ	-0.031 (0.5)		
Parental SES	-0.13 (2.3)*	-0.08 (1.7)	-0.12 (2.1)*
Relative Weight		0.15 (3)**	
Skin Color			0.087 (0.7)

Table A15: Regression models predicting whether an individual dated interracially within Hispanics.

Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
IQ	0.32 (2.8)**		0.29 (2.4)*
Parental SES	0.67 (4.8)***	0.78 (7)***	0.65 (4.6)***
Height		0.26 (3.1)**	0.28 (2.6)**

Table A16: Regression models predicting whether an individual dated interracially within Blacks.

Parameter	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
IQ	0.45 (4.5)***	0.51 (5.1)***	0.44 (4)***
Parental SES	0.33 (2.4)*		0.28 (2)*
Skin Color		-0.121 (1.2)	-0.12 (1.2)

Table A17: Standardized difference in each variable between those who have and have not dated interracially. Positive sign means higher for interracial daters. *** -> p < .001, ** -> p < .01, * -> p < .05. Sample size in parenthesis.

Parameter	White	Black	Hispanic
Attractiveness	-0.17 (1762)**	0.086 (503)	-0.071 (248)
Height	0.02 (2194)	-0.04 (678)	0.12 (302)
Relative Weight	0.011 (2194)	-0.24 (678)*	-0.062 (302)
Conscientiousness	0.032 (2190)	-0.035 (676)	0.015 (301)
Extroversion	-0.0081 (2191)	0.098 (675)	0.11 (302)
Agreeableness	0.017 (2189)	0.21 (675)*	0.31 (302)**
Openness	0.048 (2172)	0.2 (670)*	0.25 (300)*
Neuroticism	0.13 (2189)*	-0.16 (675)	-0.17 (301)
Vocabulary Score	-0.21 (2029)***	0.26 (624)*	0.75 (289)***
Parental Education	0.0096 (2194)	0.14 (678)	0.77 (302)***
Impulsivity	0.15 (2112)**	0.093 (640)	0.017 (289)
Diagnosed Mental Illness	0.13 (2194)*	0.33 (678)***	0.34 (302)**
Drug use	0.1 (2194)	0.35 (678)***	0.31 (302)**
Sex partners	0.18 (2194)**	0.21 (678)*	0.43 (302)***
Risk-taking	0.16 (2194)**	0.35 (678)***	0.36 (302)**
Criminality	0.063 (2194)	0.041 (678)	0.23 (302)*
GFP	0.0078 (2194)	0.23 (678)*	0.32 (302)**

Table A18: Odds ratio of variables predicting likelihood of mating interracially by race. *** -> p < .001, ** -> p < .01, * -> p < .05. Sample size in parenthesis.

Parameter	White	Black	Hispanic
Speak English at home	x0.62 (2194)	(not applicable)§	x4.36 (302)***
Born in USA	x1.02 (2194)	x0.27 (678)*	x3.36(302)***

§ all Black youth spoke English at home.

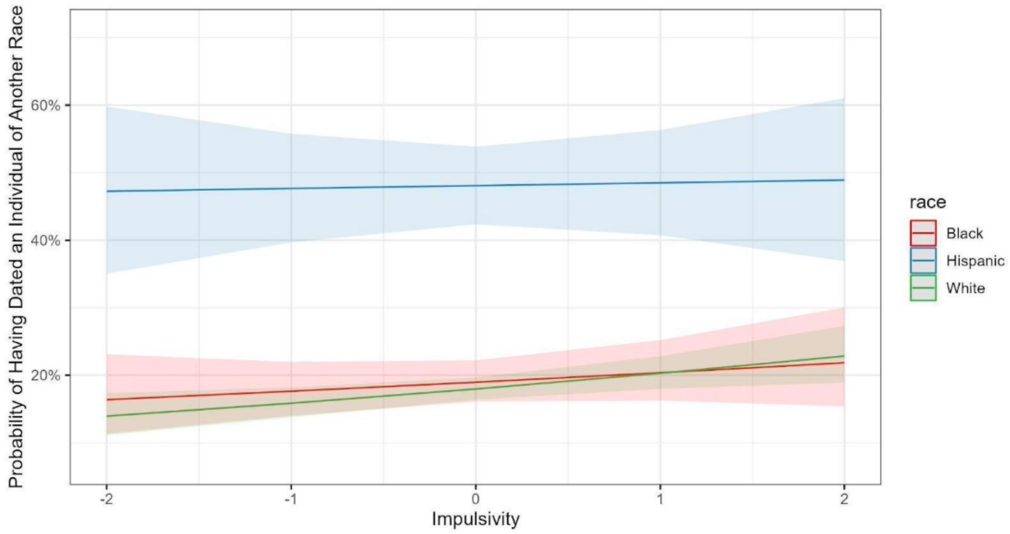

Figure A6: Impulsivity and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

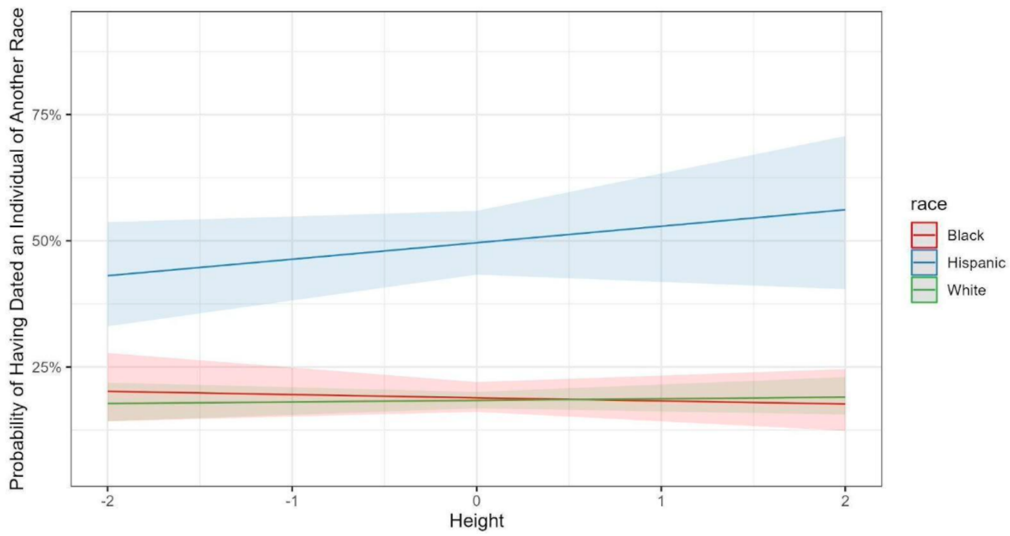

Figure A7: Height and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

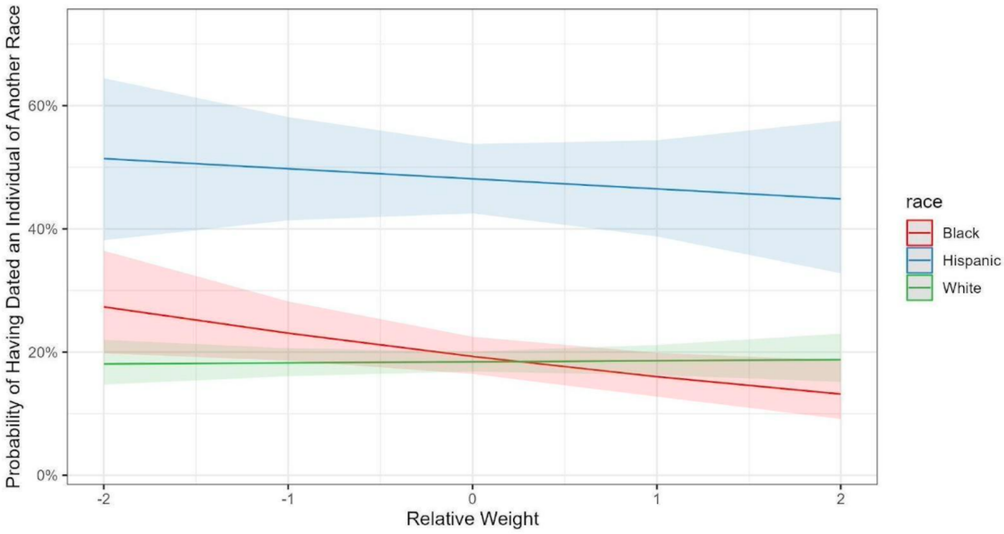

Figure A8: Relative Weight and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

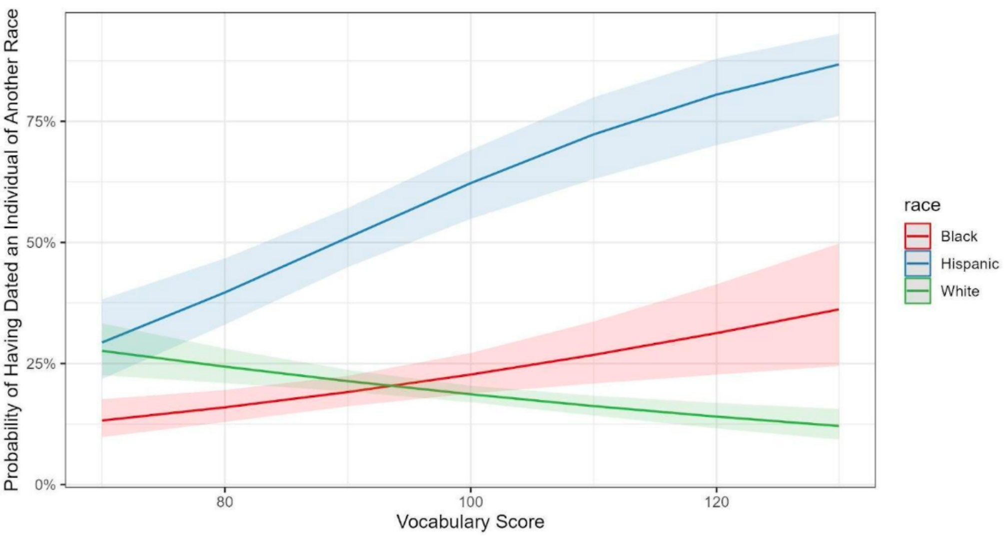

Figure A9: Vocabulary Score and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

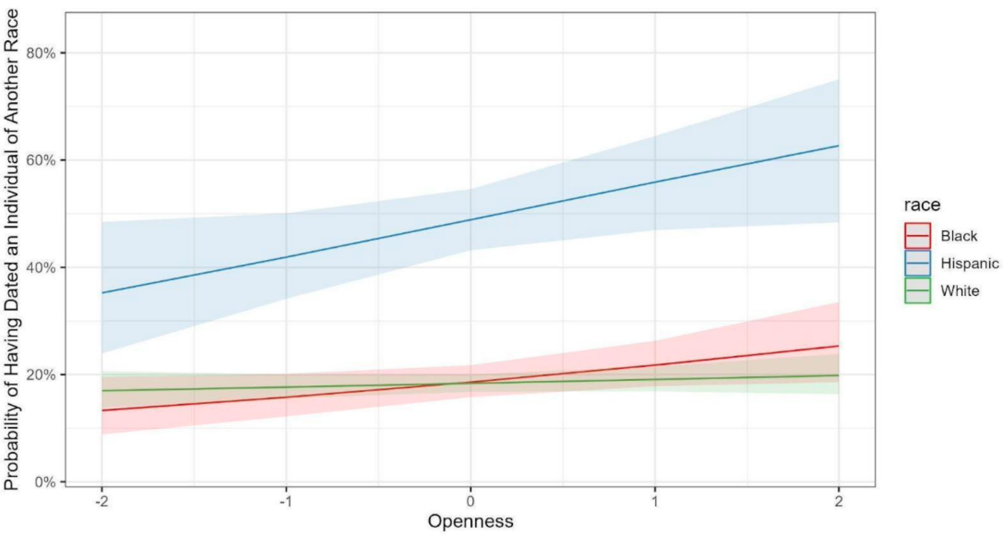

Figure A10: Openness and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

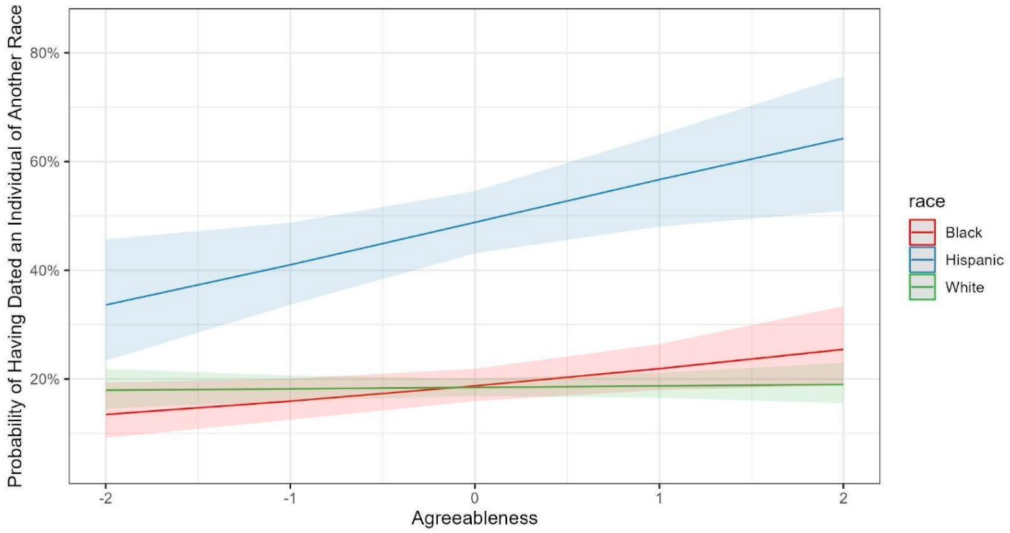

Figure A11: Agreeableness and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

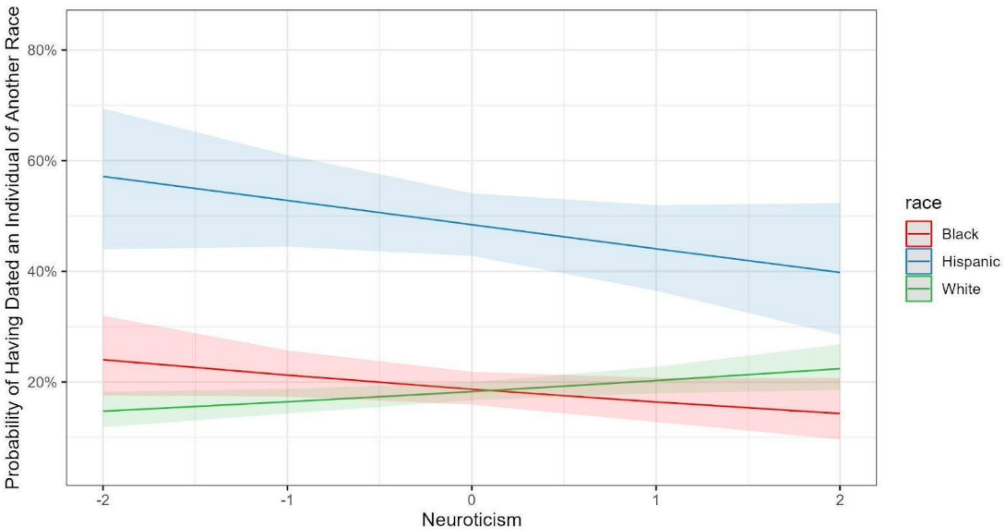

Figure A12: Neuroticism and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

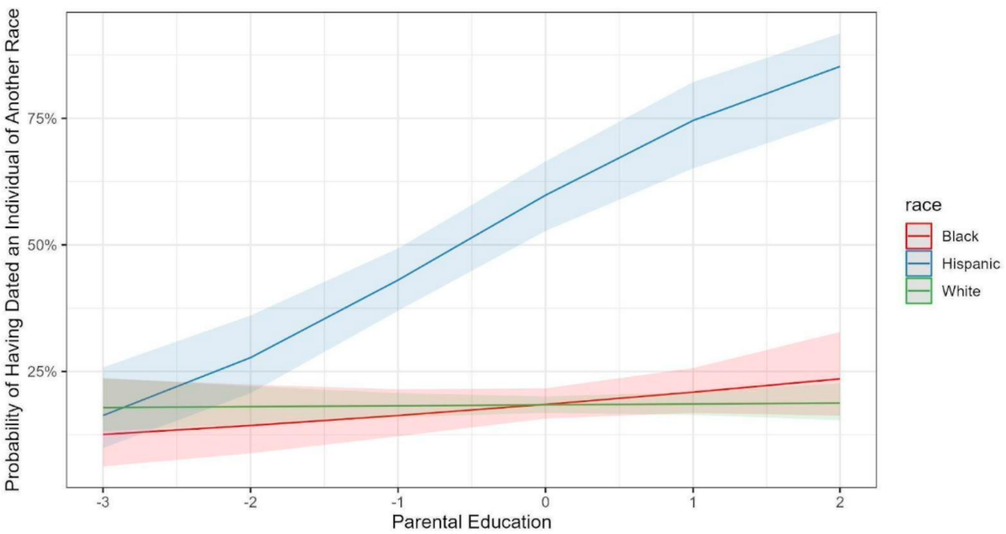

Figure A13: Parental Education and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

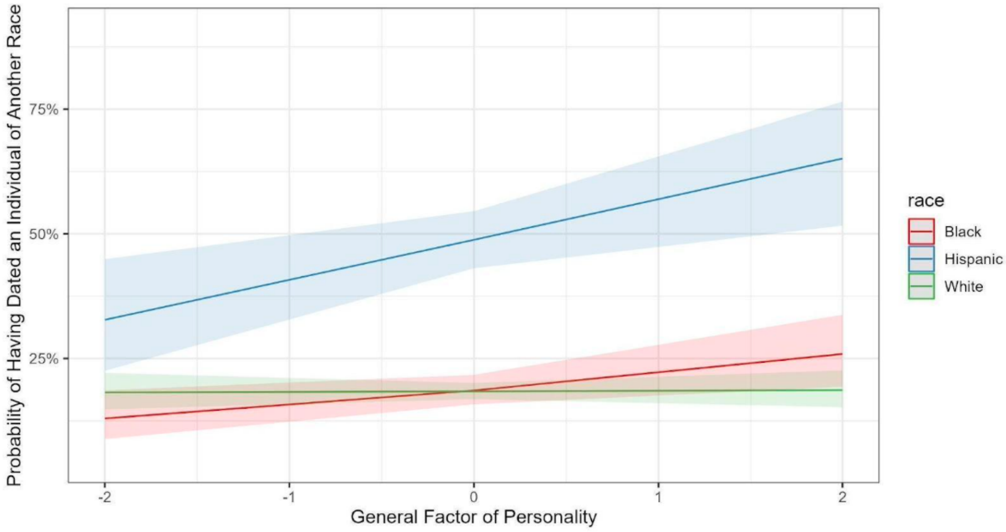

Figure A14: GFP and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

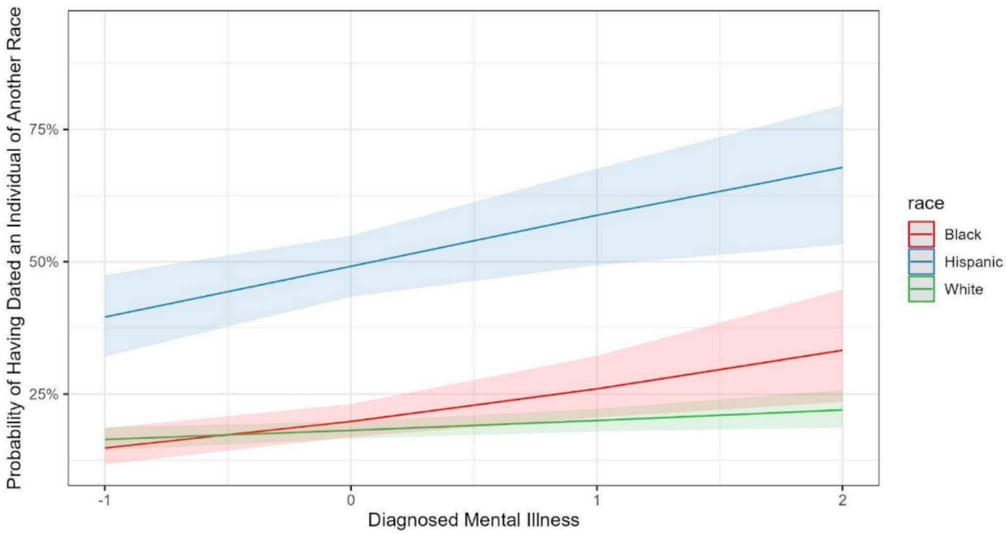

Figure A15: Diagnosed Mental Illness and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

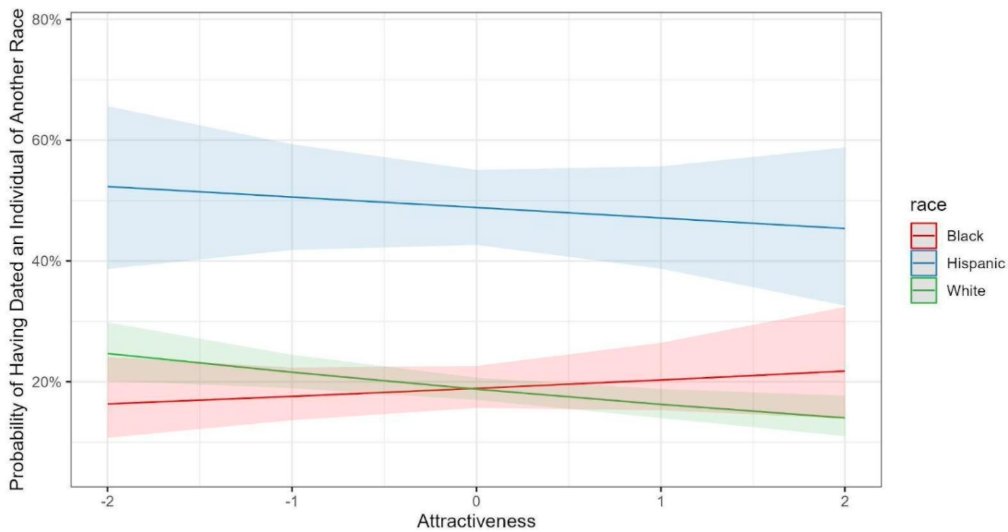

Figure A16: Attractiveness and Probability of Having Dated Interracially.

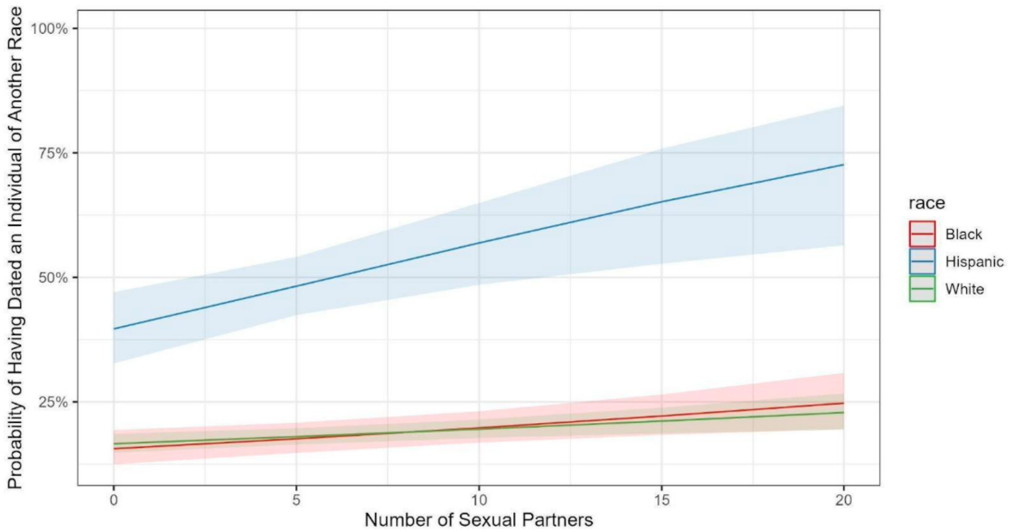

Figure A17: Number of Sexual Partners (unstandardized, unadjusted) and probability of Having Dated Interracially.

Table A19: Standardized differences in risk taking and general factor of personality between interracial and endogamous daters by race. Positive values indicate interracial daters are higher. Latent difference modeled with structural after measurement model.

		Cohen's *d*				
Race	Trait	SAM difference	Raw difference	CFI	RMSEA	SRMR
White	Risk-taking	0.18, $p < .01$	0.16, $p < .01$	0.97	0.036	0.024
Hispanic	Risk-taking	0.52, $p < .01$	0.36, $p < .01$	0.92	0.065	0.051
Black	Risk-taking	0.38, $p < .01$	0.35, $p < .001$	0.97	0.033	0.029
White	GFP	0.02, $p = .81$	0.01, $p = 0.89$	0.90	0.059	0.038
Hispanic	GFP	0.38, $p = 0.021$	0.32, $p < .01$	1.00	0.000	0.025
Black	GFP	0.28, $p = .027$	0.23, $p = .017$	0.95	0.052	0.036